

Home helpers

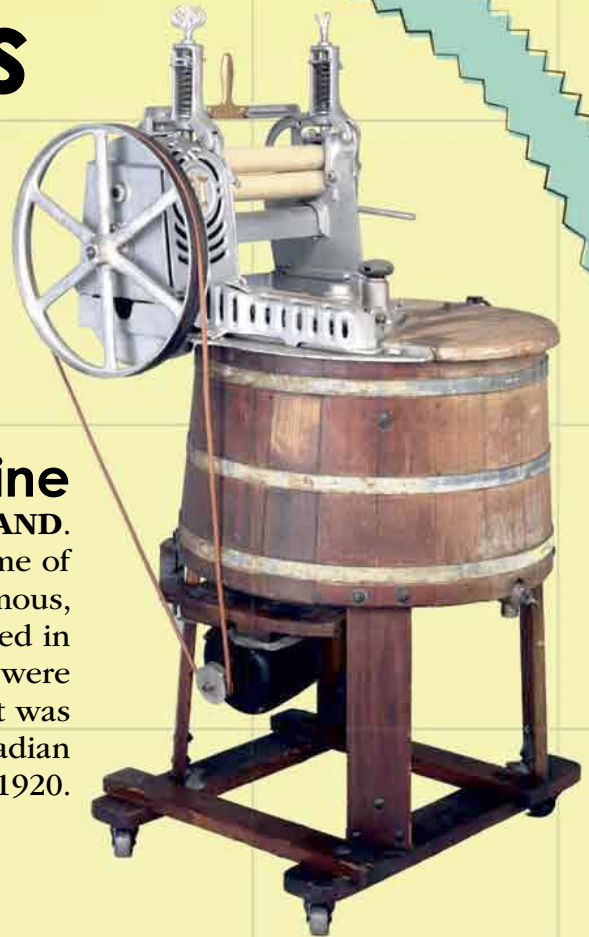
Not so long ago, cleaning and cooking were time-consuming, boring jobs. These clever devices lend a hand around the home so we can spend our time in more interesting ways.

The **APPLIANCE** of science

Washing machine

Imagine having to wash and dry your clothes **BY HAND**.

The first domestic washing machines removed some of the strain but were hand-powered, while enormous, clanking, steam-powered washing machines operated in businesses. Finally, **electric washing machines** were invented in the early 20th century—one of the first was invented by American **Alva Fisher** in 1908. This Canadian version dates from around 1920.



Vacuum cleaner

Starting in 1901, British engineer **Hubert Cecil Booth** offered vacuum cleaning to rich Londoners with his huge **HORSE-DRAWN**, gasoline-driven machine, from which a long hose would snake into the house through a window. **James Spangler**, a janitor in a US department store, invented a much smaller electric vacuum cleaner in 1907. He started a business that later became the Hoover Company.



Can opener

After canned food was invented in 1812, there was a long wait to open it safely. Canned army rations had instructions to use a **HAMMER AND CHISEL**.

People bashed and gouged away until 1870, when American inventor **William Lyman** patented a can opener with a cutting wheel. In the 1920s, safer rotary can openers were invented, based on Lyman's design.

